PP-B-81J
October 23, 1986
SUPERSEDING
PP-B-81H
SEPTEMBER 16, 1976

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BACON, SLICED, CHILLED OR FROZEN

This specification is approved by the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) for use by all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification is for the procurement of sliced bacon.

1.2 Classification. The product shall be one of the following types or styles as specified by the purchaser.

Type I - Chilled.
Type II - Frozen.

Style A - One-pound, vacuum packed.
Style B - Bulk packaged, shingled.
Style C - Bulk packaged, layout.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government publications. The issues of the following documents, in effect on date of invitation for bids or solicitation for offers, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

AMSC N/A PSC 8905

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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U.S. Department of Agriculture

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers
Visual Aids for Inspection of Rigid and Semirigid Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

Military Standard

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or solicitation for offers shall apply:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 2200 Mill Road, Alexandria, VA 22314.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Source of commodity. Bellies used shall be from hogs slaughtered in, and the finished product shall be prepared and handled in, an establishment regularly operated under the Meat and Poultry Inspection (MPI) Regulations of the USDA. Finished product, however, may be frozen and stored in commercial cold storage warehouses approved by MPI.

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Physical requirements. The bacon shall meet the limitations in tables I and II.

3.2.2 Other ingredients. Other ingredients (salt, curing ingredients, sweetening agents, spices, flavorings, etc.) shall be as allowed under MPI Regulations to meet the end item requirements.

3.3 End item requirements.

3.3.1 Slice count. Slice count of the bacon shall be 18-22 slices per pound. However, lots with different slice counts shall be discounted as indicated in procurement data (see 6.1c.).

3.4 Temperature.

3.4.1 Chilled. Sliced bacon to be delivered chilled shall be maintained between 28°F and 40°F.

3.4.2 Frozen. Sliced bacon to be delivered frozen shall be at 0°F or below within 72 hours after examination for finished product characteristics.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Examination and certification by the Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) shall not relieve the contractors of their obligation to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting it to AMS for any examination.

4.2 Examination and supervision. Product acceptability shall be determined by an AMS agent. In accordance with Meat Grading and Certification Branch Instructions, the local meat grading supervisor will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure specification compliance. The cost of all grading and certification services performed by the AMS agent involving services (including samples for fat, moisture, and salt content analyses and charges for such analyses), and travel and mileage charges, when applicable, shall be borne by the contractor.

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4.3 Examination of finished product.

4.3.1 Lot. Except as otherwise specified, examinations performed for specification compliance shall be done on a production lot basis by the AMS agent. For the purpose of this specification, a production lot is: (1) the quantity of finished product designated by the contractor as the unit for determining compliance with specification requirements; or (2) that portion of a contractor's designated production lot which the AMS agent designates as a unit for determining compliance if, in the agent's opinion, that portion is or may be out of compliance with one or more specification requirements. Unless otherwise specified, the lot size shall not exceed an offer unit or the amount of product produced in a single workshift.

4.3.2 Slice count. All sliced bacon shall be examined for slice count. No reexamination of rejected lots for slice count shall be authorized. Unless otherwise specified, slice-count requirements will be based on the number of one-pound sample units indicated in TABLE I. The lot shall be rejected if the average slice count is less than 16 or more than 24 slices. Any individual sample unit with less than 15 slices or more than 25 slices per pound (453.6 g) shall cause rejection of the lot. However, lots shall be discounted as indicated in the procurement data (see 6.1c.). (The AMS agent shall record on the certificate the average slice count for each lot.)

4.3.3 Physical characteristics examination. The sampling plan used shall be that set forth in TABLE I. Classification of defects shall be in accordance with TABLE II.

TABLE I. SAMPLING PLAN FOR FINISHED PRODUCT (SLICED)
PHYSICAL CHARACTERISTICS

Lot Size (pounds)	Sampling Size (1-lb. unit)	Defect Categories			
		Major		Minor	
		AC	RE	AC	RE
1,200 or less (544.3 kg or less)	20	2	3	3	4
1,201 to 10,000 (544.8 to 4,535.9 kg)	32	3	4	5	6
10,001 to 40,000 (4,536.4 to 18,143.7 kg)	50	5	6	7	8
Reinspection of lots 10,001 to 40,000 (4,536.4 to 18,143.7 kg)	80	7	8	10	11

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TABLE II. FINISHED PRODUCT DEFECTS FOR SLICED BACON

Categories Major	Minor	Defects 1/ 4/
101		Less than 1.0 pound (453.6 g) net weight (applicable to Style A only).
102		Bone measuring more than 0.3 inch (7.6 mm) in any dimension.
103		Cartilage measuring more than 0.3 inch (7.6 mm) in any dimension.
104		Presence of skin measuring more than 0.3 inch (7.6 mm) in any dimension. 2/
105		Two or more slices containing dark, seedy, mammary tissue measuring more than 0.3 inch (7.6 mm) in any dimension. 2/
106		Three or more adjacent slices with a fold measuring 1.0 inch (2.54 cm) or more in height. 2/ 3/
	201	Three or more adjacent slices with a fold measuring 0.5 inch (1.27 cm) or more but less than 1.0 inch (2.54 cm). 2/ 3/
	202	Three or more adjacent slices measuring more than 10.0 inches (25.4 cm) in length. 2/
	203	Presence of glandular material on the surface and measuring 0.2 inch (5.1 mm) or more in any dimension on 3 or more adjacent slices. 2/
	204	Presence of comb hanger mark on 2 or more slices. 2/
	205	More than one slice folded over or under adjacent slices for a distance of 3 or more slices. 2/
	206	Separation of more than one-half the length of 3 or more adjacent slices. 2/
	207	Break more than one-half the width of 3 or more adjacent slices. 2/
	208	More than 1 slice less than 8.0 inches (20.3 cm) in length. 2/
	209	Two or more slices containing a bruise measuring more than 0.3 inch (7.6 mm) in any dimension. 2/

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TABLE II. DEFECT CLASSIFICATION FOR SLICED BACON (CON'T...)

Categories Major	Minor	Defects 1/ 4/
	210	Presence of uncured area on 2 or more slices measuring more than 0.5 inch (12.7 mm) in any dimension. 2/
	211	Two or more slices overlap each other more than 0.5 inch (1.27 cm) measured along the length of the slices. 2/ 5/

1/ Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, grease, or metal) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.

2/ The defects noted shall be scored only once per sample unit.

3/ Measured perpendicular to an imaginary line which coincides with the outer edge of the slice.

4/ Any product not in excellent condition shall cause rejection of the lot.

5/ Applicable to Style C product only.

4.3.4 Product content testing. Withdrawal of samples for analytical requirements shall be as follows:

Style A: One-pound package - Seven adjacent slices from each of 16 randomly selected and separately boxed sample unit packages shall be used for chemical analysis. The 7 adjacent slices shall be randomly selected from the package.

Style B: Bulk, shingle - Seven adjacent slices from each of 16 randomly selected and separately boxed tray layers shall be used for chemical analysis. The 7 adjacent slices shall be randomly selected from the layer.

Style C: Bulk, layout - Seven adjacent slices from each of 16 randomly selected and separately boxed layout sheets shall be used for chemical analysis. The 7 adjacent slices shall be randomly selected from the layout sheet.

The slices selected as stated above shall be cut into approximate 1.0 inch (25.4 mm) sections, thoroughly mixed, and ground through a 0.125 inch (1/8 inch, or 3.2 mm) plate or similarly comminuted. The thoroughly mixed sample shall be divided into approximate thirds and distributed as follows:

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1. One-third shall be submitted to the AMS laboratory.
2. One-third shall be submitted to the contractor.
3. One-third shall be retained by the AMS agent as a reserve sample to be used if the original is lost or if requested by AMS or contractor.

However, analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original analysis indicated that the involved lot will be discounted or rejected because of noncompliance with fat, salt, or moisture content requirements. When the reserve sample is analyzed, analyses for fat, salt, and moisture will be performed, and the results of such analyses shall be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor.

4.3.5 Analysis of samples. Moisture, fat, and salt content shall be determined in an AMS laboratory in accordance with the Official Methods of the Association of Analytical Chemists.

Moisture content. If the analytical moisture content exceeds by more than 3 percent the calculated moisture content [78.60 - (0.8 x analytical fat)], the lot shall be rejected.

NOTE: The purchaser may specify discounts to analytical moisture contents exceeding the calculated moisture content by 0.01 to 3.00 percent (see 6.1...).

Fat content. If the analytical fat content exceeds 61.00 percent, the lot shall be rejected.

NOTE: The purchaser may specify discounts for product having an analytical fat content from 58.01 to 61.00 percent (see 6.1e.).

Salt content. The product will be rejected if the salt content exceeds 2.5 percent.

4.4 Examination for condition of shipping containers. Examination for determining compliance shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers. The applicable Visual Aids for Inspection of Containers shall be used by the AMS agent as references when determining the severity of container defects.

4.5 Examination of packaging. Examination for packaging requirements shall be in accordance with the appropriate sampling plan in TABLE III. Examination for defects shall be in accordance with TABLE IV.

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TABLE III. SAMPLING PLAN FOR PACKAGING

Lot Size (pounds)	Sampling Size (package)	Defect Categories			
		Major		Minor	
		AC	RE	AC	RE
1,200 or less (544.3 kg or less)	20	2	3	3	4
1,201 to 10,000 (544.8 to 4,535.9 kg)	32	3	4	5	6
10,001 to 40,000 (4,536.4 to 18,143.7 kg)	50	5	6	7	8
Reinspection of lots 10,001 to 40,000 (4,536.4 to 18,143.7 kg)	80	7	8	10	11

TABLE IV. PACKAGING DEFECTS

Categories		Defects
Major	Minor	
101		Packaging material missing or torn.
102		Packaging material unclean.
103		Packaging material does not cling tightly to product.
104		Not completely enclosed.
	201	Position of slices not parallel to the long axis of tray or board (applicable to Style A only).
	202	Trays or boards not coated or treated to make them grease proof. 1/
	203	Closure not as specified.
	204	Not packaged as specified.
	205	Weight of product not as specified.

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1/ Bulk packaged shingle boards must be grease proof on both sides; layout bulk and one-pound package boards or trays need only be grease proof on product contact side.

Note: The remaining section 4 requirement is for the Department of Defense procurements when specified by the contracting officer.

4.6 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Weight of product packed or number of packages not as specified.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging, packing, and marking requirements.

5.1.1 Sliced, one-pound package. One pound (453.6 g) of sliced bacon shall be vacuum packaged in a bag made of polyethylene terephthalate film laminated to polyethylene film or polyionomer laminated to nylon. The slices shall be shingled in accordance with standard commercial practice and placed on a grease-proof tray or board before packaging. The slices shall be placed parallel to the long axis of the tray or board. After vacuum packaging and sealing, the package shall cling tightly and may be placed in cartons normally used for this purpose.

5.1.2 Bulk packaged, shingled. Multi-shingled, bulk-sliced bacon may be packaged 3 shingles per package. No shingle shall weigh more than 6.0 pounds (2.7 kg), and no package shall weigh more than 16.0 pounds (7.3 kg). Each layer of the product shall be placed on a sheet of bleached sulfite or sulfate paperboard which has been coated or treated to make both sides grease-proof. As an alternative, corrugated fiberboard which is grease-proof on both sides may be used for this purpose. The shingled slices shall be packaged in a heat shrinkable bag made of polyvinyl chloride with food-grade plasticizers or copolymer of vinyl chloride and vinylidene chloride or polyethylene terephthalate film laminated to polyethylene film or polyionomer laminated to nylon. The bag shall be closed under a vacuum with a metal clip or a heat seal. The filled and sealed bag shall be subjected to a heat shrink process which will cause the bag to cling tightly to the product.

5.1.3 Bulk packaged, layout. Layout bulk sliced bacon shall be packaged 9 or 10 slices per sheet of parchment, parchmentized paper, or plastic. The slices

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shall not overlap each other. Sufficient sheets shall be packed into a shipping container to a net weight of 15 pounds. One sheet may contain less than 9 slices to make the net weight. A sheet of paper shall be placed over the top layer prior to closure.

All packaging materials shall be verified by the contractor's certificate of conformance (COC).

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Packing of bacon. Unless otherwise specified, not more than 55.0 pounds (25.0 kg) of bulk shingled bacon nor more than 24 one-pound (453.6 g) packages shall be packed in an individual shipping container.

Bulk layout bacon shall be packed 15 pounds per individual shipping container. For layout bulk bacon: (1) The container shall be lined with a plastic bag of sufficient size to completely line the interior of the box. (2) The open end of the bag shall be of sufficient length to provide adequate overlap when both edges of the bag are folded along the center of the container.

5.2.2 Fiberboard container. Product shall be packed into new corrugated fiberboard (Type CF) or solid fiberboard (Type SF) regular slotted containers (RSC). These containers shall be class domestic with a minimum bursting strength of 275 psi. The AMS agent shall use the boxmaker's certificate label to determine minimum bursting strength. Containers shall be packed to full capacity without slack filling or overfilling.

5.2.3 Container closure. Fiberboard containers shall be securely closed using one, or a combination, of the following methods:

Strapping. Two lengthwise straps shall be applied over the outer flaps, and two girthwise straps shall be placed to divide the box into units of approximately equal length. When ths method is used, initial closure shall be in accordance with the gluing or stapling method.

Gluing. A sufficient amount of glue or hot-melt adhesive shall be applied to prevent lifting of edges and corners of the outer flaps.

Stapling. Staples shall be of sufficient number and distributed to securely close and prevent lifting of edges and corners of the outer flaps. The gluing, taping, or strapping method shall be used for the final closure.

Taping. Commercially acceptable tape, 2.0 inches (5.1 cm) wide, shall be centered over the seam(s) formed by closure of the outer flaps. The tape shall extend onto the end panels to securely close and prevent lifting of edges and corners of the outer flaps.

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NOTE: The AMS agent maintains the right to verify, using appropriate test procedures, that packaging and packing materials comply with these requirements.

5.2.4 Sealing and stamping containers. Filled containers of sliced bacon shall be sealed and stamped in accordance with Meat Grading and Certification Branch Instructions.

5.3 Markings. Shipping container markings shall be as prescribed in applicable contract or solicitation document.

NOTE: The remaining section 5 requirements are for the Department of Defense procurements when specified by the contracting officer.

5.4 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1f.).

5.4.1 Level A packing. Not more than 24 one-pound (453.6 g) packages, nor more than 55.0 pounds (25.0 kg) of bulk shingle, nor more than 15.0 pounds (6.8 kg) of bulk layout bacon, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with Style RSC-L, Grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.4.2 Level B packing. Not more than 24 one-pound (453.6 g) packages, nor more than 55.0 pounds (25.9 kg) of bulk shingle, nor more than 15.0 pounds (6.8 kg) of bulk layout bacon, packaged as specified in 5.1., shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with Style RSC-L, Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.4.3 Level C packing. Not more than 24 one-pound (453.6 g) packages nor more than 55.0 pounds (25.0 kg) of bulk shingle, nor more than 15.0 pounds (6.8 kg) of bulk layout bacon, packaged as specified in 5.1., shall be packed in a shipping container complying with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the final closure of fiberboard boxes.

5.5 Labeling and marking.

5.5.1 Packages. Packages shall be labeled in accordance with Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

5.5.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

Any procurement activity outside the Federal government may utilize this specification or any modification thereof. USDA certification may also be specified by these activities, but modification of the document will not be allowed without appropriate approval from the Market Research and Development Division located at:

U.S. Department of Agriculture
Agricultural Marketing Service
Market Research and Development Division
14th and Independence Avenue, SW
Washington, DC 20250

6.1 Procurement data. The procuring agency shall specify in the contract or solicitation document the following, as applicable:

a. Product type (Type I or Type II).
b. Product style (Style A, Style B, or Style C).
c. Slice count (if other than specified herein) and discount range, if any.
d. Moisture content (if other than specified herein) and discount range, if any.
e. Fat content (if other than specified herein) and discount range, if any.
f. Packaging and packing requirements (if other than specified herein).
g. Shipping container markings.
h. Offer unit size.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MS, MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - MRD
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - MRD

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